

CSS Cheatsheet for Beginners

A quick reference for core CSS concepts, selectors, and layout tools

1. How to Add CSS

```
<!-- Inline -->
<p style="color: red;">Text</p>

<!-- Internal -->
<style> p { color: red; } </style>

<!-- External (best practice) -->
<link rel="stylesheet" href="styles.css">
```

2. Selectors

Selector	Example	Targets
Element	p {}	All <p> tags
Class	.box {}	class="box"
ID	#header {}	id="header"
Universal	* {}	Everything
Descendant	div p {}	p inside div
Child	div > p {}	Direct children
Group	h1, h2 {}	Both h1 and h2
Pseudo-class	a:hover {}	Link on hover
Pseudo-element	p::first-line {}	First line

3. Box Model

Every element is a box: **content → padding → border → margin**

```
div {
  width: 200px;
  padding: 10px;
  border: 2px solid black;
  margin: 20px;
  box-sizing: border-box;
}
```

4. Colors & Units

```
color: red;
color: #ff0000;
color: rgb(255, 0, 0);
color: rgba(255, 0, 0, 0.5);
color: hsl(0, 100%, 50%);
```

- **px** — fixed pixels
- **%** — relative to parent
- **em** — relative to parent font-size
- **rem** — relative to root font-size
- **vw / vh** — % of viewport width/height

5. Text & Fonts

```
font-family: "Helvetica", sans-serif;
font-size: 16px;
font-weight: bold;
font-style: italic;
text-align: center;
text-decoration: underline;
line-height: 1.5;
letter-spacing: 1px;
```

6. Display & Positioning

```
display: block | inline | inline-block | none | flex | grid;

position: static | relative | absolute | fixed | sticky;
top: 0; left: 0; right: 0; bottom: 0;
z-index: 10;
```

7. Flexbox (1D layout)

```
.container {
  display: flex;
  flex-direction: row | column;
  justify-content: center | space-between | space-around;
  align-items: center | flex-start | flex-end;
  gap: 10px;
}
.item {
  flex: 1;
}
```

8. Grid (2D layout)

```
.container {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: 1fr 1fr 1fr;
  grid-template-rows: auto;
  gap: 20px;
}
.item {
  grid-column: span 2;
}
```

9. Backgrounds & Borders

```
background-color: #f0f0f0;
background-image: url("image.jpg");
background-size: cover;
border-radius: 8px;
box-shadow: 2px 2px 10px rgba(0,0,0,0.2);
```

10. Responsive Design

```
@media (max-width: 768px) {
  .container { flex-direction: column; }
}
```

11. Common Pseudo-classes

```
a:hover {}
button:active {}
input:focus {}
li:first-child {}
li:last-child {}
li:nth-child(2n) {}
```

12. Handy Reset

```
* {
  margin: 0;
  padding: 0;
  box-sizing: border-box;
}
```

Quick Tips

- Use classes for styling, IDs sparingly (mainly for JS hooks/anchors).
- Flexbox for rows/columns; Grid for full page layouts.
- `rem` for font sizes keeps things accessible.
- Browser DevTools (right-click → Inspect) is your best friend for testing CSS live.